

A new home for the words.

Kabita Live: from the first idea to a hosted literary journal



A rain-washed Odisha courtyard: the welcoming image at the heart of the new homepage.

When I began working on Kabita Live, the intention was straightforward: give the magazine a website that reflected the care already present in its poetry. The publication had its own history, editors, contributors and monthly rhythm. I wanted readers to feel that richness as soon as they arrived.

We started by exploring the existing website: following its navigation, opening editions, reading poems and visiting contributor pages. We asked how the experience felt on a phone, how much room the writing received, and whether Odia, Hindi and English were equally comfortable to read.

That first study gave us a direction: a calm, welcoming literary journal, rooted in Odisha and generous to all three languages.

A character, built through choices.

Warm paper, deep ink, thoughtful typography and a sense of place



[Current issue](#) [Poems](#) [Poets](#) [Editors](#) [Archive](#)

SEPTEMBER 2026 · ISSUE 47 · 16 POEMS

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*The fragrance of earth.
The voice of the heart.*

[Read this edition](#)

Monthly poetry · Odia, Hindi & English

*"Poetry is an echo,
asking a shadow to dance."*



LIFE AS IT IS

A poem to begin with.

[All poems](#)

The hosted homepage: a clear invitation to the current edition, with space for the artwork and language.

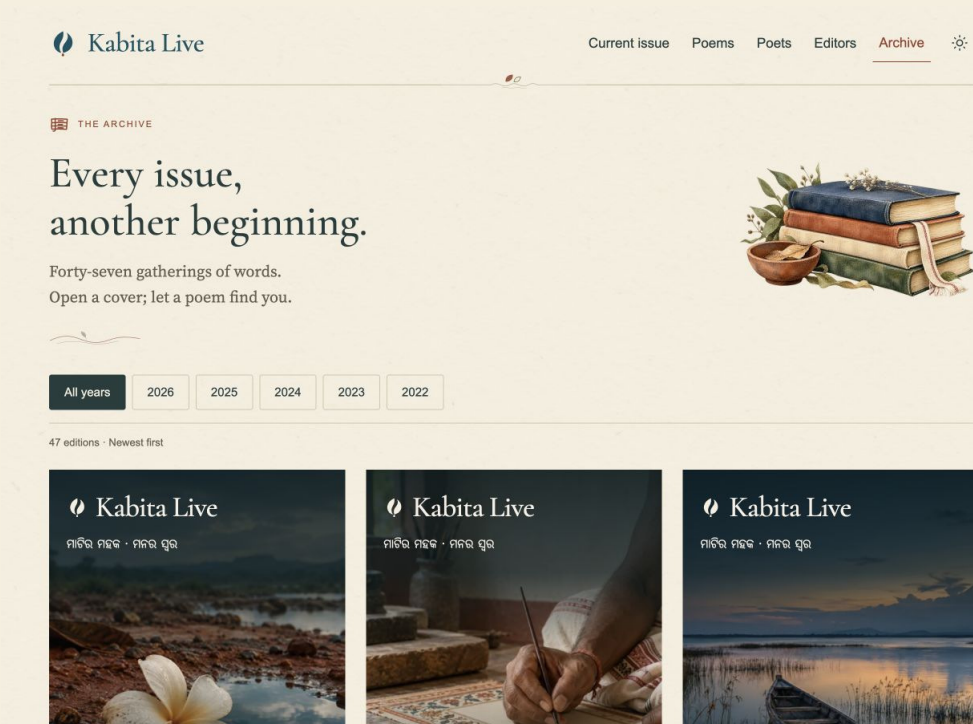
The visual identity developed through many small decisions. We explored mastheads, colours, artwork and page compositions. The familiar Kabita Live name stayed at the centre, accompanied by its Odia signature. Warm paper, deep ink, laterite tones and watercolour imagery became a consistent visual language.

Typography was chosen for each script and tested with real poems. We paid attention to line breaks, stanza spacing and longer passages. On phones, the writing needed to remain comfortable without squeezing names or titles.

We compared alternatives and revised them repeatedly. Sometimes an improvement meant a different layout; sometimes it meant moving a link, reducing a gap or removing a repeated label. The design system grew out of those decisions.

Bringing the archive together.

Preserving the magazine while making its connections easier to follow



The archive gives each edition a recognisable cover and a direct path to its poems.

47
EDITIONS

799
ACTIVE POEMS

427
ENRICHED PROFILES

As the design took shape, the scale of the content work became clear. We captured 47 editions and 801 poem records, preserving the original material while connecting poems to their editions and contributors. We investigated incomplete entries, separated accidentally combined works and reconciled duplicated passages. Two unavailable entries were retained in the archive and removed from active editions.

The poets' pages required their own research: literary backgrounds, names, book references and contribution histories. We prepared and applied 427 enriched narratives. Where evidence was limited, we kept the introduction modest and grounded in the writer's available work.

A similar name was never enough to merge two people. Quotations had to remain faithful to their poems. Confirmed duplicate profiles were brought together; a small number of identity and credit questions remain recorded for the editors.

Made for staying with a poem.

A quieter reading experience, with the poet close at hand

Alongside the archive, we developed search, adjustable text, light and dark appearances, bookmarks, underlining and a quiet reading mode. We tested how poems flowed across pages and how readers moved through an edition or a poet's collection.

Translation drafts were prepared for editorial review. Audio was explored, then deferred when the results did not meet the standard we wanted.

Artwork received the same care. Covers gained distinct visual stories, and poem illustrations were connected to their imagery. A watercolour portrait treatment was developed from existing photographs. Originals and earlier studies were preserved; the portrait work continues in reviewed batches.



Narmada Nilotpala

An artistic portrait drawn from an existing photograph.

← Exit reading

🔖 Aa

pouring out from my restless pores
all night.
At daybreak I am convinced
that nothingness
can be converted into thingness
though it needs a lot of love
for undeterred pain and resolute anguish.

Mrittika



Anindita Bose

At twilight I received a gift from you
a space that you have been creating
for a long time,
perhaps it was never meant for me
but most things on earth are predestined

I waited up there with a hope to listen

the stories of life and beyond,
the space that belongs to you has a
mystic essence that every human shall
experience soon...

Yet today when I was there I felt a kind
of selfless love that is carried by old souls
to spread the light and wisdom

You have the power to share with the world
the dreams that most humans wish to fulfill,
your pains and scratches have turned into
the pillars of others' destinies...

I am a soul just passing by yet I stopped at
your grounded farm, to meet the cat and
the dog, to rejuvenate my own visions...
I am a healer and I need a space where I
can be my true bare self...

←

22-23

→

Quiet reading on the hosted site. "Mrittika" by Anindita Bose, Issue 47.

Ready to welcome readers.

The redesigned website is hosted; the domain transition comes next



We also prepared for the people who would use and maintain the site: an editor cheat sheet, a fuller design walkthrough and PDF, clearer credits and acknowledgements, and a completed Facebook presence.

Throughout the process, I directed the choices and worked with AI assistance on research, design, implementation and checking. We kept decisions, sources, original artwork and revisions so the work could be understood and maintained beyond this first effort.

Today, the redesigned Kabita Live is hosted and available to review and share. The deployment checks passed, and we tested live search, the poem reader, poet profiles and mobile layouts. The existing domain is unchanged while we prepare for the DNS transition.

We began with an intention to make the magazine easier and more inviting to read. We have arrived at a working literary home that carries its history forward and gives its poems room to be discovered.

Explore the hosted Kabita Live

ahimanikya.github.io/kabita-live

Design direction and story: Ahimanikya Satapathy, with AI assistance. Poetry belongs to its authors. With acknowledgement to the editors and contributors, and to Sonu Swayin and Versatile IT Services Pvt. Ltd. for hosting and managing Kabita Live since inception.